

## 2.5 [www.batchmates.com](http://www.batchmates.com)

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Batchmates is an alumni database service which claims to be India's largest. It aims to separate long lost friends and colleagues from kindergartens, schools, colleges and offices who may have drifted apart from each other. Batchmates says that they have facilitated



more than 1500 meetings and about 1000 new people are joining everyday. These stats, apart from the Indian flavor of the site as well as the apparent usefulness inspired us to take it out for a test drive.

We came back impressed. The homepage has no bells or whistles, nor is it eye candy, but is efficient in conveying the intent of what the site was designed for. You get a list of all the states and Union Territories. The first thing to do is to select the state where your school or college is located. After selecting the state you get a list of cities and towns in that state arranged according to alphabetical order. To verify the reach which Batchmates claims to have, we selected Assam. We were forced to dump our cynical attitude when the site threw up places in Assam which even people who have lived there have not heard much about. Impressive!

And the great part of this is that all this can be done without registration, which is superb. Why register if you can't find your school later? Of course only members can add schools or colleges of their own. You can join more than one institution at the same time. In fact Batchmates aims to trace your whole journey from kindergarten to retirement.

Once you become a registered member you can do most of the things that you do when you meet old friends. Exchange messages, post photos, talk about first crushes and describe what you did